

LAYER 2

The Binding Operation ($\oplus$)

Six rules that depend on type and order. The core mechanism of the Prismatic System.

What Is Binding?

Binding combines two elements and produces a numerical result. The symbol for binding is $\oplus$.

The critical concept: the rule changes depending on which types you are combining AND which element is on the left versus the right.



Order matters. $A \oplus B$ is NOT always the same as $B \oplus A$. Always check: what is LEFT? What is RIGHT?

There are two categories of binding:

1. Same-type binding (both elements are the same type) → always ADD
2. Mixed-type binding (different types) → 6 different rules depending on L/R order

Same-Type Binding: Always Add

When both elements are the same type, the rule is simple: add their values. Order does not matter here because addition is commutative.

$$\text{Glyph}_1 \oplus \text{Glyph}_5 = 1 + 5 = 6$$

$$\text{Ring}_2 \oplus \text{Ring}_3 = 4 + 6 = 10$$

$$\text{Shard}_1 \oplus \text{Shard}_4 = 1 + 16 = 17$$

Practice: $\text{Shard}_3 \oplus \text{Shard}_1 = ?$

Answer: $9 + 1 = 10$ (same type $\rightarrow$ add)



Same-type bindings can NEVER produce a negative result. Adding two positive values is always positive.

Glyph $\oplus$ Ring: Multiply | Ring $\oplus$ Glyph: Add

When a Glyph is LEFT and a Ring is RIGHT $\rightarrow$ MULTIPLY their values.

$$\text{Glyph}_1 \oplus \text{Ring}_4 = 1 \times 8 = 8$$

$$\text{Glyph}_6 \oplus \text{Ring}_1 = 6 \times 2 = 12$$

When a Ring is LEFT and a Glyph is RIGHT $\rightarrow$ ADD their values.

$$\text{Ring}_4 \oplus \text{Glyph}_1 = 8 + 1 = 9$$

$$\text{Ring}_1 \oplus \text{Glyph}_6 = 2 + 6 = 8$$

Glyph₁ $\oplus$ Ring₄

MULTIPLY

$$1 \times 8$$

$$= 8$$

$\neq$

Ring₄ $\oplus$ Glyph₁

ADD

$$8 + 1$$

$$= 9$$

Glyph $\oplus$ Shard: S-G | Shard $\oplus$ Glyph: S+G

Glyph LEFT, Shard RIGHT $\rightarrow$ Shard value MINUS Glyph value. Can produce negatives!

$$\text{Glyph}_1 \oplus \text{Shard}_4 = 16 - 1 = 15$$

$$\text{Glyph}_6 \oplus \text{Shard}_2 = 4 - 6 = -2 \quad \leftarrow \text{negative result!}$$

Shard LEFT, Glyph RIGHT $\rightarrow$ Shard value PLUS Glyph value. Always positive.

$$\text{Shard}_4 \oplus \text{Glyph}_1 = 16 + 1 = 17$$

$$\text{Shard}_2 \oplus \text{Glyph}_6 = 4 + 6 = 10$$

Practice: $\text{Glyph}_4 \oplus \text{Shard}_1 = ?$ and $\text{Shard}_1 \oplus \text{Glyph}_4 = ?$

$$\text{Answers: } 1 - 4 = -3 \quad | \quad 1 + 4 = 5 \quad \leftarrow \text{completely different results!}$$

Ring $\oplus$ Shard: $R \times 2 - S$ | Shard $\oplus$ Ring: $S - R$

Ring LEFT, Shard RIGHT $\rightarrow$ Double the Ring value, then subtract the Shard value.

$$\text{Ring}_1 \oplus \text{Shard}_2 = (2 \times 2) - 4 = 0$$

$$\text{Ring}_4 \oplus \text{Shard}_1 = (8 \times 2) - 1 = 15$$

Shard LEFT, Ring RIGHT $\rightarrow$ Shard value minus Ring value.

$$\text{Shard}_2 \oplus \text{Ring}_1 = 4 - 2 = 2$$

$$\text{Shard}_1 \oplus \text{Ring}_4 = 1 - 8 = -7$$

Practice: $\text{Ring}_3 \oplus \text{Shard}_1 = ?$

$$\text{Answer: } (6 \times 2) - 1 = 11$$

Binding Reference Table

Here is the complete binding table. Rows = LEFT element, Columns = RIGHT element.

	→ RIGHT element		
↓ LEFT	Glyph $\triangle$	Ring $\circ$	Shard $\diamond$
Glyph $\triangle$	ADD $G_1 @ G_5 = 6$	MULTIPLY $G_1 @ R_4 = 8$	S - G $G_6 @ S_2 = -2$
Ring $\circ$	ADD $R_4 @ G_1 = 9$	ADD $R_2 @ R_3 = 10$	R × 2 - S $R_1 @ S_2 = 0$
Shard $\diamond$	S + G $S_4 @ G_1 = 17$	S - R $S_1 @ R_4 = -7$	ADD $S_1 @ S_4 = 17$

⚠ Before ANY binding: (1) What TYPE is on the left? (2) What TYPE is on the right? Then apply the correct rule.